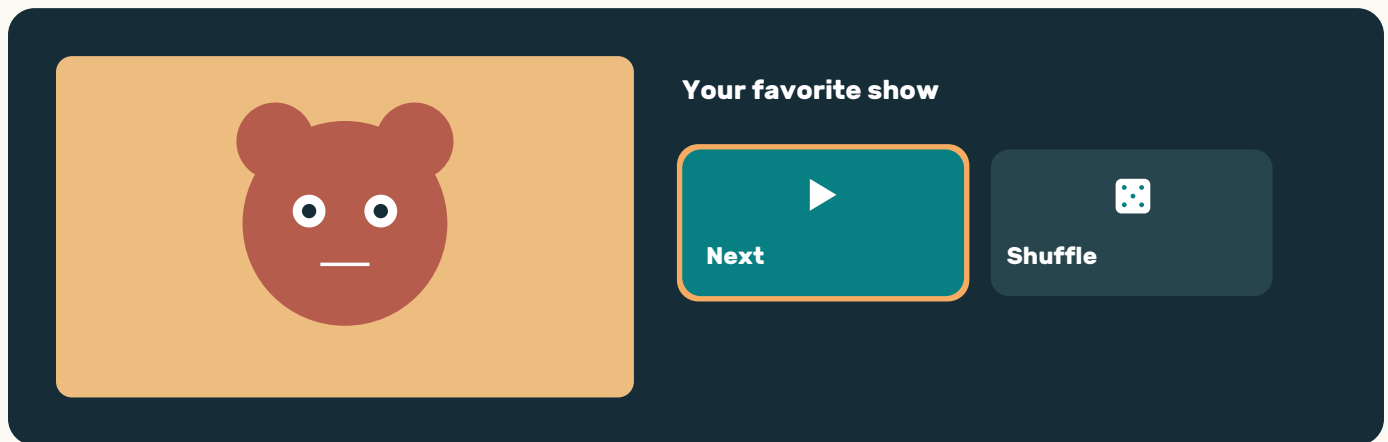


A PRODUCT MEMO FOR THE SENIOR FATHERHOOD EXECUTIVE

Their shows. Their remote. Your peace of mind.

JellyfinPlayer, redesigned for children who choose by picture. Version 1.0 of the proposal; all new product behavior is subject to your review.

The pitch. Give the kids a small, familiar television universe: choose a character, press Next or Shuffle, and watch. Give the grown-ups confidence about what can appear, what plays next, and how to stop. The return on investment is fewer support calls from the sofa.



More radio, less iTunes. We already have a working media server and a Swiftfin-derived client that can stream from it. The opportunity is to turn that technical capability into a calm household product: a dependable player with a deliberately small number of choices.

The approval requested: endorse a focused first release with Shows and Movies, two actions per show, one primary action per movie, and protected grown-up controls. Build a testable slice before investing in polish.

Concept illustration above. This is a product design proposal, not a screenshot of the current app.

01 / EXECUTIVE BRIEF

A simpler remote. A quieter household.

The product succeeds when a child can start something appropriate and a parent can trust the result.

The problem we are solving

A general media client asks viewers to understand libraries, seasons, episode lists, resume states, and settings. Those are useful tools for a collector. For a child who cannot read, each one can become a request for help. Our household also needs a firm boundary between kids' content and everything else on the server.

The product promise

For the child	For the grown-up
Recognizable pictures, stable positions, obvious focus.	Only Kid TV and Kid Movies are eligible to appear or play.
Two decisions: choose a show; choose Next or Shuffle.	Next is predictable; shuffle does not scramble ordered progress.
An easy way back when something goes wrong.	Failures recover calmly and expose useful details only to parents.

Why this is worth building now

The current fork has passed a real LAN simulator test: login, catalog browsing, episode and movie playback, seeking, and retained login after restart. The server corroborated DirectPlay for a movie. This proves the playback foundation; it does not yet prove the kids' interface, restricted access, or long-term reliability. [E1]

Executive posture: keep the proven playback foundation, reduce the visible product, and validate with the actual family. No public launch, new server platform, or broad media migration is required for this proposal.

Decision rights. You approve household rules and content eligibility. The child supplies usability evidence. Product and engineering translate both into a small, testable interface.

02 / CHARTER AND SCOPE

A small product with a clear boundary.

Initial audience: one household, a child who cannot read, one Apple TV, and a parent who administers Jellyfin separately.

Job	What good looks like
Child: "I want my show."	Identify familiar art and start playback without reading or asking for help.
Child: "Surprise me with this show."	Start a different episode of the chosen show without managing a queue.
Parent: "Keep the choices appropriate."	Curate the two approved libraries and verify that no other material is reachable.
Parent: "Make TV easy to stop and fix."	Control autoplay, choose a specific episode, and recover from a lost connection.

In the first release

Shows as the landing screen; a persistent Shows / Movies switch; artwork grids; Next and Shuffle on each show; Play or Resume on a movie; simple playback controls; a session end card; protected episode selection and settings; dedicated restricted credentials; recovery for connection and authentication failures.

Deliberately outside the first release

Cross-show "Play anything" radio, separate child profiles, cross-device progress sync, global search, discovery feeds, trailers, cast pages, downloads, Live TV, purchases, voice search, server administration, and enforceable screen-time scheduling. Public App Store distribution and TestFlight setup are separate delivery work.

Success is measured in household outcomes

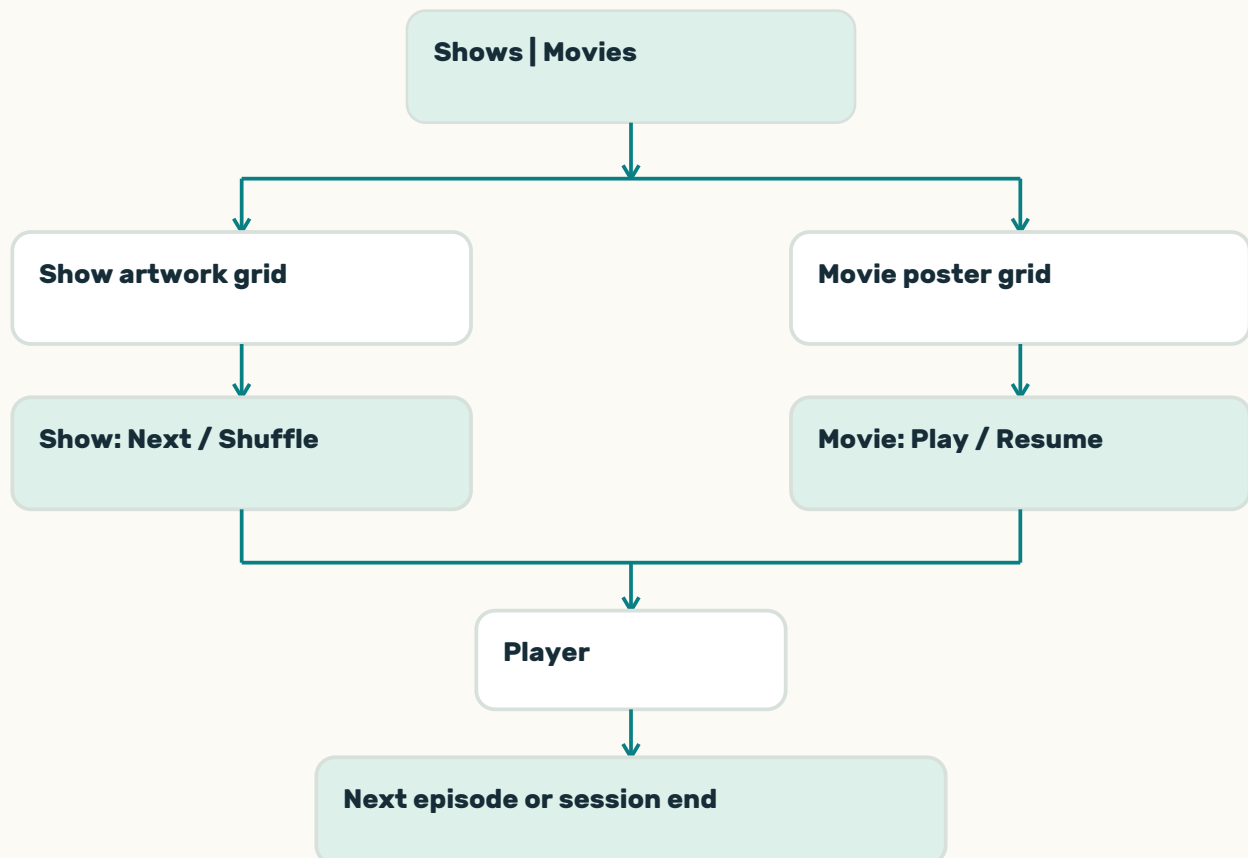
The child can start and leave a video independently. The parent rarely needs to rescue navigation. No content outside the two approved libraries can leak through artwork, queues, links, or playback. A longer viewing session is not inherently a better outcome.

Unchanged commitments: do not modify or delete RAID files; do not expand the original Plex-indexed catalog automatically; preserve the curated library boundary. This proposal does not retire Plex or claim unattended server startup is solved.

03 / INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

One front door. A short path to play.

Launch into Shows. Movies is always one top-level choice away. Advanced navigation stays behind the parent gate.



Back is a promise. Player returns to the originating title. Title returns to the same grid card and scroll position. Back from Movies returns to Shows; Back from Shows follows the normal tvOS app exit behavior. No circular routes or surprise destination changes.

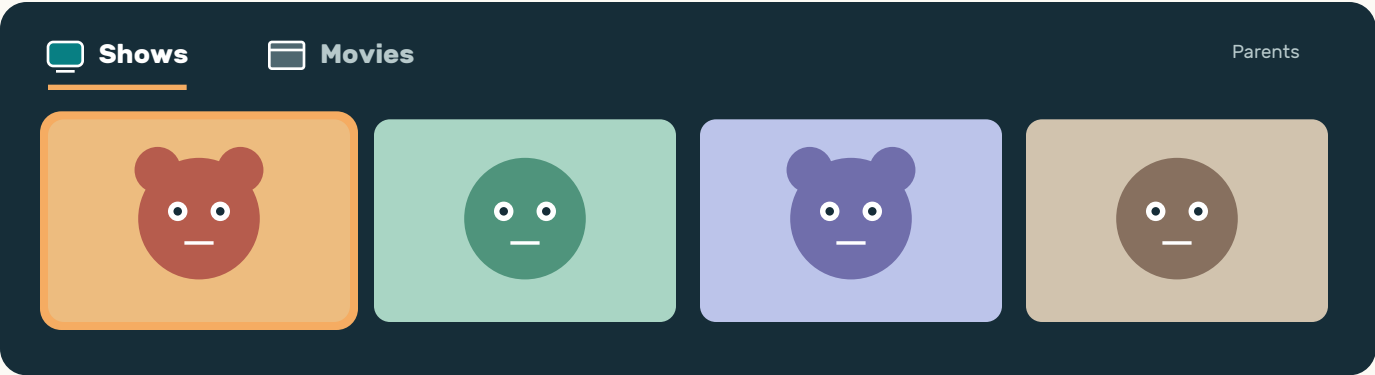
Parent route. A small Parents control on each browse screen opens a PIN gate, then: Choose Episode; Playback & Session; Accessibility; Connection; Help. Exiting or backgrounding relocks the area. It never exposes the rest of the media catalog.

Exceptional routes: first-run setup and expired login require a parent. Empty library, loading, unavailable content, reconnecting, and session finished are designed states, not generic error dialogs.

04 / BROWSE SCREENS

Recognition does the work.

Use the collection as a shelf of familiar pictures. Keep navigation stable and avoid competing rails of recommendations.



CONCEPT / SHOWS LANDING SCREEN / GENERIC ILLUSTRATIVE ART

Element	Proposed behavior
Shows / Movies switch	Two large icon-and-word tabs in a fixed position. Selecting a tab changes the grid; merely focusing it does not. Shows is the cold-launch default.
Artwork grid	Start with four large cards per row and two visible rows at TV scale. Stable server sort order, no wraparound at grid edges, no automatic reordering during use.
Focused card	Use the platform focus system with a clear enlargement and high-contrast edge. Artwork and short accessible title identify the same item. [S1]
Return location	Restore the card, row, and scroll position when returning. Preserve browse state during temporary backgrounding; a cold launch starts calmly at Shows.
Missing art or empty library	Use a friendly, distinct placeholder with a title and optional spoken label. Empty library shows a simple illustration and a route to the other category; setup details stay in Parents.

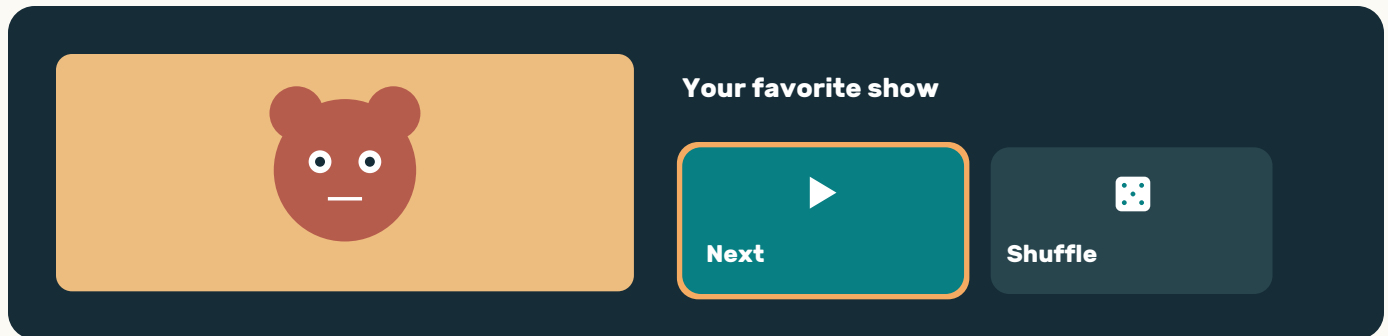
Movies uses the same grammar. Keep the same switch, focus behavior, and card spacing, with poster-shaped images. No trailers on focus, scrolling text walls, or hidden context menus. A child should learn the interface once.

Content refresh: apply new artwork and ordering on the next browse visit, preserving the focused item by ID when it still exists. Newly approved additions may appear; a scan must never broaden access by itself.

05 / TITLE SCREENS

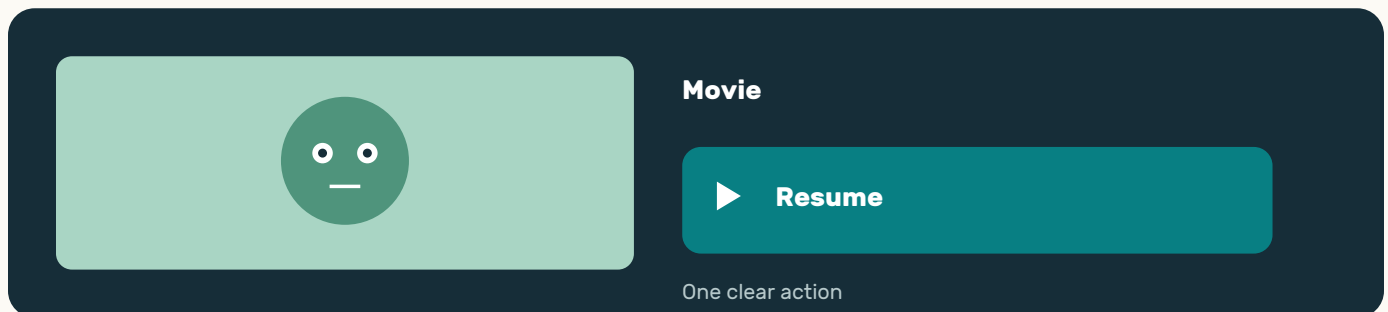
A show offers two choices. A movie offers one.

The title screen establishes intent before playback. Every show behaves the same way.



Show. Familiar hero artwork, a short title, Next, and Shuffle. Focus starts on Next. Use a play pictogram for Next and a distinctive dice pictogram for Shuffle, paired with accessible labels. Test comprehension; neither icon is assumed to be obvious.

Next resumes the ordered episode or starts the next one in sequence. Shuffle starts an eligible episode from this show at its beginning. No season picker, ratings, plot summary, cast, technical metadata, or recommendation rail appears here.



Movie. Show the poster or backdrop and one large Play button. If unfinished progress exists, that action becomes Resume with a small progress indicator. A completed movie offers Play again. Start over is available in the parent area; there is no automatic next movie.

Small exceptions, same shape: at the end of an ordered series, Next becomes Again, with a replay pictogram. For a one-episode show, keep Shuffle in place and explain the limited choice through optional narration. With no eligible episodes, show an unavailable state instead of an enabled play action.

Concept screens. Validate artwork, scale, and contrast in the simulator and from the sofa.

06 / PLAYBACK CONTRACT

Next remembers a journey. Shuffle makes a station.

These are explicit product rules. They prevent a random episode from unexpectedly changing where the family is watching in order.

Rule	Next / ordered	Shuffle / random
Starting point	Resume the current ordered episode at its saved position; otherwise begin the next regular episode. A new show starts at its first regular episode.	Choose from a randomized bag of eligible episodes in this show; begin at 0:00.
What advances	Advance the ordered cursor when playback naturally ends, or when a parent explicitly marks an ordered episode complete.	Remove a started episode from the current bag. Refill only when exhausted; avoid an immediate repeat if another episode exists.
Resume after leaving	Save ordered position on pause, exit, and periodic checkpoints. Next resumes that position.	A new press of Shuffle means a new draw. Temporary interruption recovery resumes the current item; leaving the show ends that shuffle session.
After an episode	Play the next eligible ordered episode if autoplay and the session budget permit it.	Draw another episode from the same bag if autoplay and the session budget permit it.
Effect on other mode	Ordered state belongs to this app and household profile. It does not follow generic Jellyfin watched flags.	Playback may update Jellyfin history, but cannot move or reset the app's ordered cursor.

The eligible episode set

Intersect authorized items with the approved library IDs. Order playable regular episodes by season and episode; exclude specials, trailers, extras, and inaccessible items. Missing or duplicate numbering requires parental review. Never infer eligibility by scanning raw media folders.

Reconcile additions by stable item ID without moving progress backwards. A missing current item preserves the cursor and offers an explicit next eligible episode. Changed identities after a server rebuild require parent remapping.

State ownership: local, versioned state keyed by server, account, show, and item IDs. One Apple TV in v1; parent-only export/reset. No cloud sync or Plex history migration.

07 / PLAYER AND SESSION ENDING

Keep the video central. Make stopping ordinary.

The radio metaphor reduces repeated decisions. It does not require endless playback.

Moment	Child-facing behavior
While playing	Video dominates; controls disappear after inactivity. Respect standard remote Play/Pause. Select reveals controls; selecting the focused central control toggles playback.
While paused	A large play action and a simple timeline. Left/right seek only while the timeline has focus; show a clear position preview. Back first dismisses controls, then exits to the title.
Episode ending	If another episode is permitted, show its picture and a 10-second visual countdown. Stop is immediately available and focused; pressing it returns to the show. Back also cancels. No automatic focus jump while the child navigates.
Session finished	A calm end card with the show's picture and one Back to shows action. No countdown and no next video. Pressing Back has the same destination.
Movie ending	Return to the movie screen after completion. No automatic switch to another movie.
Recoverable interruption	Pause the session, keep the item and position, and show a reconnecting state. Do not consume the episode budget or silently switch titles.

Recommended household default

At parent setup, propose **two episodes per session**; offer one, two, or continuous. Resumed episodes count on completion; failed starts do not. Ordered mode stops at the final episode. Shuffle may refill its bag while budget remains; randomly playing a finale does not end that session.

The budget persists across app interruptions so a crash does not restart its count. At the end card, a child can return and start another session. Therefore this is a convenient stopping point, **not a screen-time lock**. An enforced daily limit would be a separate feature with different requirements.

Scope choice: no child-facing Skip episode button in the first version. Back, then Next resumes; Back, then Shuffle asks for a new draw. Parents can select a specific episode without adding controls to every viewing session.

08 / INTERACTION AND ACCESSIBILITY

Make the whole sofa feel at home.

Reading ability, motor precision, familiarity with the remote, and hearing are separate constraints. Test them separately.

Visual language

Use a quiet dark viewing surface, large recognizable artwork, restrained motion, and one unmistakable focused control. Pair color with shape, position, and contrast. Keep Next and Shuffle in the same locations on every show. A decorative animation must never delay an action or become the only status signal.

Input or state	Interaction requirement
Directional navigation	Every movement lands on a visible, reachable control. No diagonal-only targets, focus traps, hidden swipe gestures, or wraparound surprises.
Selection	One deliberate activation starts one action. Debounce repeated presses while connecting; do not launch duplicate playback sessions.
Back	Unwind one visible level at a time, with the player overlay dismissed first. Restore prior focus when returning; maintain the same behavior in failure states.
Spoken navigation	Offer parent-enabled spoken titles and action names after focus settles. Cancel stale announcements. Avoid double speech when VoiceOver is active.
System accessibility	Provide labels, roles, values, and focus order for all controls. Respect reduced motion and applicable system display preferences. Validate with VoiceOver rather than relying on icons alone.
Loading and errors	Use pictures plus short optional speech; keep status visible without flicker. Do not place raw network messages or credentials in child-facing views.

A practical child test

After one demonstration, ask the child to find a familiar show, start it, stop it, switch to a movie, and return. Observe without prompting unless frustration rises. Record the exact point where assistance was needed. Repeated mis-selection is a design failure, not a training obligation.

Apple recommends system focus behavior and stable focus transitions. This proposal applies that guidance; the child-specific layout and narration choices are hypotheses to test. [S1]

09 / THE PARENT EXPERIENCE

Advanced controls stay available. They stay out of the way.

The parent gate controls complexity. Server authorization controls which content exists in this app.

Parent screen	Elements and behavior
Gate and setup	A parent-selected PIN distinct from Jellyfin credentials. Entry masks digits; repeated failures back off without trapping the child. Back returns to browsing. Exit, backgrounding, and inactivity relock the area.
Choose episode	Show picker restricted to Kid TV, then seasons and episode thumbnails. Retain the last browsed show as the initial selection. Play once returns to the show after completion and leaves the ordered cursor unchanged. Set Next here explicitly changes that cursor.
Playback & Session	Autoplay count, movie Start over, and per-show ordered progress reset. Confirm resets; never offer delete media. Content curation remains in Jellyfin.
Accessibility	Spoken navigation preference, preview of speech, and accessible guidance for system options. Ordinary playback can still expose captions and audio choices to the parent.
Connection & Help	Server identity, connection test, restricted account status, last successful playback, and sanitized diagnostics. Sign-out or account replacement requires the parent gate.
Recovery	A documented parent recovery path can reset app settings and sign in again. Loss of local progress is explained; resetting the app never changes media or broadens library access.

Administration remains in Jellyfin

Parents add and correct media through the established server administration workflow. This app refreshes its approved catalog after those changes; it does not import folders, edit metadata, create sidecars, rename files, or delete media. The app carries no server-admin credential.

No adult catalog inside the gate. Unlocking Parents permits specific episode selection and settings within the kids' catalog only. If you want to watch other libraries, use a separate adult client. This app also cannot govern other apps or system navigation on the Apple TV.

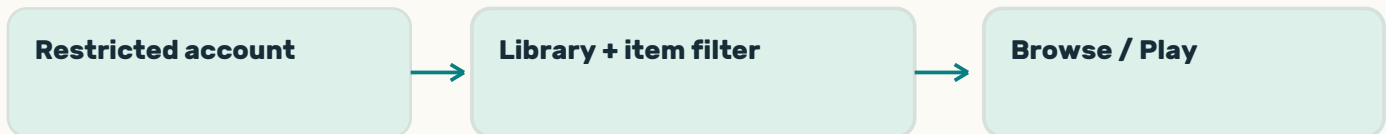
10 / CONTENT AND TRUST BOUNDARY

Two libraries, enforced twice.

Hiding tabs is insufficient. The account and every client entry point must agree about what is allowed.

Server boundary. Provision a dedicated non-admin Jellyfin account with access only to the audited Kid TV and Kid Movies library IDs. Disable access to all libraries and media deletion. Jellyfin supports explicit library permissions, including keeping newly added libraries inaccessible by default for such users. Verify the actual running server behavior. [S2]

Client boundary. Bind setup to server identity and approved library IDs, using names as labels only. Scope browse, artwork, resume items, episode selection, playback queues, and incoming links to that allowlist. Reject an unapproved item even if an upstream response contains it. Disable inherited routes that cannot meet this rule.



Fail closed, including old state

If approved libraries disappear or change identity, present parent setup instead of substituting another library. On account, server, or library-binding change, discard cached artwork and queues before rendering new content. On ordinary launch, show neutral loading until authorization is confirmed. If the server cannot confirm eligibility, do not serve a cached offline catalog or start playback.

Revalidate membership and authorization before every new item. An active stream may briefly continue from its buffer during an outage; revocation is enforced at the next successful authorization check or explicit denial. Test that behavior and do not promise instantaneous deletion of already delivered frames.

The RAID remains immutable

All app state, logs, caches, and server-generated artifacts stay on internal storage under the established write-protection design. Use Jellyfin APIs to read the curated catalog; never enumerate the RAID. Parent-approved future additions are separate from this redesign, and must preserve the audited source boundary.

Known gap: the current development account was used for broad playback validation. It is not evidence that a child-restricted account or every inherited Swiftfin route already meets these requirements. No server permissions are changed by this document.

11 / RELIABILITY AND IMPLEMENTATION

Preserve the working player. Build the smaller product around it.

Proposed architecture: a kids-specific presentation layer, a catalog authorization layer, and explicit playback/session state around the existing Swiftfin foundation.

Condition	Required response
App restart or crash	Restore credentials from Keychain, validate the account, then show the safe landing screen. Preserve ordered progress and session budget; do not autoplay immediately after launch.
Wi-Fi or server outage	Attempt bounded reconnects with visible feedback. After roughly 15 seconds, offer Try again and Back. Preserve position; never silently advance to another episode.
Expired credentials / 401	Stop retrying the same token, hide cached content, and ask for a parent. Do not expose an unrestricted account chooser or raw server response.
Missing media / bad stream	Do not alter the ordered cursor. Offer retry or an explicit next eligible item when available. Record a sanitized reason for the parent; do not loop forever.
Server or app update	Run the approved smoke test before considering the update accepted. On a broken build, return to the last known working client without changing the media store.
Out-of-order response	Cancel superseded browse requests and playback starts. Bind responses to the current account and library scope so stale results cannot reappear.

Engineering plan, without a rewrite

Reuse verified connection and playback paths. Add state for focus, ordered progress, shuffle, and session budget; checkpoint atomically every 10 seconds and on transitions. Keep one playback owner. A technical spike must verify navigation seams and item-to-library membership APIs before estimating implementation.

Retain the signed simulator build that fixed Keychain persistence, and audit inherited navigation routes. Server boot resilience remains separate: the client can recover from a restart, but cannot start an unavailable server. [E1]

Privacy: use local diagnostics and manual family testing. Never log credentials or sensitive paths. No external analytics in v1.

12 / RELEASE ACCEPTANCE

Make the promises falsifiable.

These are proposed release gates, not measured outcomes. Block release on content-boundary failures even when the main playback path works.

ID / requirement	Acceptance evidence
P0-01 / Allowed catalog	Test the kids account across browse, artwork, resume, queue, direct links, and parent episode selection with allowed/denied IDs. Zero denied items render or play.
P0-02 / Old data isolation	Seed a previous-account cache, change account or library binding, and disconnect. No old title, image, or playable item appears. Missing/recreated library requires parent action.
P0-03 / Ordered Next	Test new show, resume, completion, app kill, seek, missing item, and series end. Shuffle and Play once never move the ordered cursor.
P0-04 / Shuffle and endings	Across a complete eligible bag, no duplicate until exhaustion; no immediate repeat when avoidable. Both modes obey the budget; ordered mode also stops at series end. Test one-item bags.
P0-05 / Navigation	From each screen and state, every visible action is reachable and Back has the specified destination. Return focus survives playback and retries. Repeated Select starts only one stream.
P0-06 / Real playback	Use at least one approved Kid TV episode and Kid Movies movie. Confirm visible time progression, pause/resume, seeking, and a full episode-to-next transition with server corroboration.
P0-07 / Recovery	Interrupt network and server availability during browse and playback; relaunch the app; expire a token. Position survives and the UI recovers or requests a parent without loops or catalog leakage.
P0-08 / Household control	PIN gate relocks; all restricted actions require it. Session-end behavior is clear. No client action writes to media or enables access outside the two approved libraries.

Human gate: after one demonstration, observe five starts across two sittings. Target four without reading prompts or rescue, plus successful return from playback. This household sample guides design, not population-wide claims.

Use synthetic denied items in test fixtures. Keep sensitive media out of child tests and review screenshots.

13 / DELIVERY AND SCORECARD

Build a little. Prove it works.

Approve the direction now. Expand investment only after each stage demonstrates its household value.

Stage	Deliverable and exit gate
1 / Validate the shape	Clickable or simulator prototype of browse, title, player states, and parent route. One parent review plus a short child observation resolves Next/Shuffle icon confusion and landing-screen choice.
2 / Build the safe slice	Dedicated restricted account, two-library filter, one show, one movie, login persistence, and normal playback. Exit only after denied-route and cache-isolation tests pass.
3 / Complete the behavior	Ordered cursor, shuffle bag, autoplay budget, end card, episode picker, and recovery. Exit after the PO contract suite and approved-library simulator playback checks pass.
4 / Pilot at home	Install on the actual Apple TV when ready; verify remote focus, audio, captions, representative formats, suspend/resume, and a longer session. Then run a one-week family pilot before making it the default.

A lightweight scorecard

Measure	Initial target / how measured
Independent start	4 of 5 observed starts after one demonstration; record assistance and mis-selection, not viewing duration.
Time to picture	Warm LAN: median at most 3 seconds from Play to first visible frame over 10 representative starts. Diagnostic target; measure the actual codec and playback method.
Playback and recovery	10 of 10 sample starts succeed; all scripted recovery cases resolve or reach a clear parent action. Record stalls, restart position error, and DirectPlay/transcode method.
Boundary correctness	Zero forbidden items in the complete test matrix. Any leak blocks release regardless of usability scores.

Investment discipline. This memo does not invent a schedule or dollar estimate. First inspect the fork's navigation seams and permission behavior, then estimate each stage. If custom controls create playback regressions, simplify the interface before expanding the playback engine.

14 / EXECUTIVE DECISIONS

The choices on your desk.

Recommendations below are proposed defaults. Content boundaries and RAID immutability are existing requirements.

Decision	Recommendation	Tradeoff
Front door	Open on Shows; keep Movies adjacent.	Fastest route to familiar characters; no separate two-button home.
Session length	Propose two episodes at setup; parent may select one or continuous.	A natural stopping point without pretending to enforce daily screen time.
Random viewing	Shuffle within the selected show in v1.	Predictable content context; cross-show radio becomes a later opt-in experiment.
Series completion	Ordered mode stops at the end; offer Again on the next explicit selection.	Avoid a silent restart while retaining an easy rewatch path.
Progress ownership	One shared household profile, stored locally in v1.	Simple and predictable; reinstall can lose local ordered state, and multiple TVs do not sync.
Specific episodes	Protected parent browser; Play once does not move Next unless explicitly requested.	Keeps the child interface small while preserving adult precision.

Risks worth owning

Recognition: artwork and icons may not be understandable to this child. Mitigate with observation and optional speech. **Catalog correctness:** library membership is only as appropriate as parental curation; ratings alone are not the boundary. **Fork maintenance:** upstream changes can disturb navigation or playback; keep the custom surface small and rerun the contract suite.

Availability: Wi-Fi, server startup, and codec support still constrain playback. Measure rather than infer from one success. **Progress:** a local ordered cursor is a deliberate v1 limitation; preserve it across updates and explain reset consequences. **Household scope:** this app does not restrict other Apple TV apps or prevent the child starting a fresh session.

Recommended approval: proceed with the two-library prototype and its content-boundary tests. Review the screen flow and proposed session default before full implementation. The family gets a simpler remote experience; the Senior Fatherhood Executive gets fewer escalations.

15 / EVIDENCE AND REFERENCE NOTES

What is known.

What is still a proposal.

Prepared 29 September 2026. This is a planning artifact; creating it changed no app source, server permissions, or media.

Established in this workspace

[E1] Simulator validation, 29 Sep 2026. The local JellyfinPlayer fork built for the Apple TV simulator, signed in to 1531Server over the LAN, played an episode, sought forward, preserved login across relaunch, and played a second title. The server chat reported DirectPlay with playback advancing from 29.7 to 41.8 seconds over 12 seconds and no new server errors during those checks.

Those tests used the existing development catalog. They did not validate the proposed child-restricted account, new navigation, shuffle semantics, content filters, audio output, physical Apple TV behavior, long-duration reliability, or server boot resilience. The current source needed no playback/auth patch; paced input and a signed simulator build resolved the observed login path.

Internal evidence: [Documents/JellyfinPlayer/build/validation/SIMULATOR-VALIDATION.md](#) and its screenshots; build instructions in [Documents/JellyfinPlayer/build/LOCAL-DEVELOPMENT.md](#). Both are local records on the development Mac, not public references.

Primary references consulted

[S1] Apple Human Interface Guidelines: Focus and selection. Basis for relying on platform focus effects and avoiding unexpected focus changes. Child-specific layout and behavior in this memo remain product recommendations.

[developer.apple.com / Human Interface Guidelines / Focus and selection](#)

[S2] Jellyfin: Managing Users. Documents explicit per-library access and the behavior of new libraries when access to all libraries is disabled. The running server must still be tested with the intended account.

[jellyfin.org / Documentation / Managing Users](#)

Review map

Read for the pitch	Read for implementation
Pages 1-3: case, value, and scope. Pages 4-6: hierarchy and screen concepts.	Pages 7-12: behavior, parent controls, boundaries, and failure handling.
Page 15: recommendations requiring review.	Pages 13-14: acceptance gates, milestones, and measurement.